

ICS Activation Checklist — Water & Aquatic Safety

Printable checklist for fatal or non-fatal drowning, and water or boat incidents.

Time	Step	Actions	Lead / support	Confirmations
0–1 min	Step 1 — Raise the alarm	- Shout for help and radio: "Code Water — [location]." - Ensure rescuer safety — reach or throw, do NOT go in unless trained and safe. Use a reach pole, ring buoy, or throw line. - From a boat, throw flotation and keep the casualty in sight at all times.	1st Responder / Guide / Boat Crew	☐ Alarm raised · rescuer safety ensured
1–3 min	Step 2 — Activate ICS & retrieve	- IC activates the team; Medic moves to the scene. - OC controls bystanders and ensures safe retrieval from the water. - Suspect spinal injury if diving or a fall was involved — support the head and neck, keep the person horizontal.	IC / OC / Medic	☐ Team activated · casualty retrieved safely
3–5 min	Step 3 — Resuscitation (ABC)	- Check response and breathing. If not breathing: 5 initial rescue breaths, then CPR at 30:2; use an AED as soon as available (dry the chest first). - Place a breathing, unconscious casualty in the recovery position; treat catastrophic bleeding or spinal injury as indicated.	Medic / Responders	☐ Casualty breathing/CPR status confirmed ☐ AED used if available
5–10 min	Step 4 — Stabilise & prepare evac	- Administer oxygen if trained and available; manage hypothermia — remove wet clothing, warm and insulate, treat for shock. - LC prepares the vehicle or boat; EC contacts medical or medevac services on IC's instruction.	Medic / LC / EC	☐ Hypothermia/shock managed ☐ Transport & medevac contact prepared
10–30 min	Step 5 — Evacuation / transfer	- Evacuate per the Medical Emergency protocol — road or air evacuation as authorised by IC. - Medic monitors vitals continuously; EC logs departure time and destination.	IC / Medic / LC / EC	☐ Evacuation authorised & logged
Within 24 hrs	Step 6 — Debrief & reporting	- ERT debriefs within 2 hours; EC and IC submit the Incident Report within 24 hours. - Review supervision, equipment, and prevention; restock and check rescue and medical equipment. - Any person who experienced a drowning event with respiratory impairment, required resuscitation/oxygen, or has concerning symptoms must be medically assessed and monitored until handed over to medical care.	IC / EC / All Commanders	☐ Debrief done · report submitted ☐ Equipment restocked